

ENTREPRENEURSHIP: FROM IDEA TO MVP

Session 1 Lesson Guide — Grade 6 Founder's Journey

Subject: Entrepreneurship & Innovation

Level: Grade 6

Provider: Planrs Academy

1. Who is an Entrepreneur?

An **entrepreneur** is not simply someone who runs a shop or earns money. At their core, an entrepreneur is a **Problem Solver**. They look at everyday life in their school, home, or community and spot friction—asking key questions like: *"What is broken? What is difficult for people? How can I create a better way?"*

From your local *Kirana* store owner who makes quick home deliveries to founders of global technology platforms, every successful business starts by identifying and solving a real human problem.

Hero Case Study: The Mumbai Dabbawalas

The Problem: Thousands of office workers in Mumbai wanted hot, home-cooked lunches, but lived far away and travelled on overcrowded morning trains, making carrying lunch boxes impractical.

The Innovation: Without complex computer software or modern technology, the Dabbawalas created a color-coded logistical system using bicycles, trains, and teamwork to deliver over 200,000 lunchboxes daily with near-zero error. They solved a massive urban problem with a simple, brilliant operational system!

2. Spotting Opportunities: The "I Wish..." Game

Great business ideas do not come out of nowhere; they start with keen observation. Entrepreneurs act like "Problem Detectives". By finishing the sentence **"I wish..."**, you can uncover dozens of business opportunities right around you:

- *"I wish there was an easier way to recycle plastic at school..."*
- *"I wish healthy snacks tasted as fun and crisp as fried chips..."*
- *"I wish I could find a reliable cycle-rickshaw faster in the evening..."*

3. Understanding the MVP (Minimum Viable Product)

When you have a big business idea, you do not need to build a giant factory or spend huge amounts of money on day one. Instead, you build an **MVP**—a **Minimum Viable Product**.

Deconstructing MVP:

- **Minimum:** The absolute smallest, simplest version of your idea.
- **Viable:** It actually works and delivers real utility/value to the user.
- **Product:** Something tangible or usable that customers can test and provide feedback on.

An MVP is often referred to as the **"Cardboard and Crayon"** prototype—a quick model built to demonstrate how your idea works before investing major resources.

Real-World Case Study: How Flipkart Started Small

Before becoming an e-commerce giant, Flipkart began with just two founders working out of a small apartment . They didn't build a massive warehouse or stock millions of items . They created a basic website for books, personally bought ordered books from local markets, and delivered them on a scooter . They tested their MVP manually to verify if people trusted buying books online .

4. The Analogy: Skateboard to Car

If your ultimate dream is to build a high-performance car, **do not start by building a single wheel** . A single wheel is useless on its own—a customer cannot ride it anywhere !

Instead, build a **Skateboard** first . A skateboard is simple, low-cost, and immediately functional . It lets the user move around and gives you immediate feedback on whether they enjoy that mode of transport . Next, you upgrade it to a bicycle, then a scooter, and eventually a car ! *Always create something useful from Day 1* .

5. Iteration & The Feedback Loop

Iteration means showing your prototype to real people, gathering feedback, and making improvements step-by-step .

Example: The Street Food Chaat Vendor

When a street vendor prepares *Bhel Puri*, if a customer mentions "it is too spicy!", the vendor adjusts the chutney ratio for the next batch . That immediate adjustment is iteration in action !

The 3 Essential Feedback Questions to Ask Customers:

1. "Does this product actually solve your problem?"
2. "What is one specific thing you would change or improve?"
3. "Would you be willing to pay for this service or product?"

WORKSHEET: THE FOUNDER'S IDEA CANVAS & MVP BLUEPRINT

Complete the activities below to turn your "I Wish..." idea into an actionable business prototype!

Activity 1: Problem Detective & Idea Canvas

1. Describe the Problem you noticed in your school or neighborhood:

2. Your Solution (How does your business fix this problem?):

3. Target Audience (Who faces this problem every day?):

Activity 2: Designing Your MVP ("Skateboard" Version)

What is the simplest version of your product you can make using paper, drawings, or simple materials?

Your Final Dream Product ("Car")	Your Simple MVP Prototype ("Skateboard")
<i>e.g., A fully automated AI app that tracks school bus routes and sends alerts.</i>	<i>e.g., A WhatsApp group managed manually where drivers send location updates.</i>

Activity 3: Customer Feedback Tracker

Show your paper prototype/MVP drawing to 3 classmates or family members and record their feedback .

Tester Name	Does it solve their problem?	One suggested improvement
Tester 1:		
Tester 2:		
Tester 3:		

STUDENT PRACTICE ASSESSMENT

Review & Concept Mastery Questions — Grade 6 Entrepreneurship

Instructions: Answer all questions clearly in the spaces provided or on a separate answer sheet. No reference answers are provided on this sheet.

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions

Q1. What is the primary mindset of a successful entrepreneur?

- [A] Someone who only buys products from large stores
- [B] A problem solver who looks for ways to improve people's lives
- [C] Someone who builds expensive factories immediately
- [D] Someone who avoids talking to customers

Q2. In the term MVP, what does the letter 'V' stand for?

- [A] Valuable
- [B] Valuable-speed
- [C] Viable (meaning it actually works)
- [D] Visual

Q3. Why is building a "Skateboard" better than building just a single "Wheel" when testing an idea?

- [A] A single wheel cannot move a customer from point A to point B on its own.
- [B] Skateboards are always more expensive than cars.
- [C] Wheels cannot be recycled.
- [D] Skateboards do not require any user feedback.

Q4. How did Flipkart test its business model in its early days?

- [A] By building a massive network of 50 warehouses immediately
- [B] By manually buying books from local markets and delivering them on scooters
- [C] By selling cars online
- [D] By launching television commercials across India

Section B: Short Answer & Concept Application

Q5. Explain what **iteration** means using the example of a street chaat vendor.

Q6. What real-world problem did the Mumbai Dabbawalas identify, and what was their non-technological solution?

Q7. List the 3 key feedback questions an entrepreneur should ask potential customers during product testing.

Section C: Scenario-Based Problem Solving

Q8. Scenario: Priya notices that students in her school constantly lose their water bottles during recess. She wants to create a smart electronic tracking app to help students find them.

(a) What would be the "Wheel" mistake Priya should avoid?

(b) Design a low-cost "Paper or Cardboard MVP" that Priya could test with her classmates tomorrow before spending money.
